



Scholar: [] Class: []

MEONCROSS SCHOOL | HISTORY DEPARTMENT

HOW 'GLOBAL' WAS BRITAIN'S TRANSFORMATION BETWEEN 1450 AND 1750?

*KS3: Early Modern World & Global Encounters
(1450–1750)*

Scholar: _____

Class: _____

PROGRESS & ASSESSMENT TRACKER TARGET GRADE: _____

Level	Emerging (1-2)	Emerging+ (3)	Expected (4-5)	Expected+ (6-7) / Greater Depth (8-9)
Lesson / Assessment Title	Effort	Level	Teacher Comments	
L1: Who held global power in 1450?				
L2: How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?				
L3: Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?				
L4: James I and the Gunpowder Plot: Why was religious division so volatile?				
L5: Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle				
L6: Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift				
L7: What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?				
L8: How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?				
L9: How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)				
Assessment: End of Unit Assessment: How 'modern' was Britain by 1750?				
Final Unit Grade:				

L1: Who held global power in 1450?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Identify the major global powers and trading hubs in the year 1450.
- ☐ Explain how the Ottoman Empire and West African kingdoms controlled global wealth.
- ☐ Evaluate why Western Europe was on the periphery (edges) of world trade in 1450.

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least *THREE* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Silk Road | Ming Dynasty | Ottoman Empire

Q1. Study Source A. What does this 1375 map detail suggest about how trade was conducted between Europe and Asia before the discovery of sea routes?

Q2 Knowledge Check: Review the events of 1450.

1. Why was the fall of Constantinople catastrophic for merchants in Western Europe?

- ☐ It blocked the Silk Road trade routes
- ☐ It destroyed all European ships
- ☐ It ended the Renaissance
- ☐ It forced them to pay higher taxes to the Pope

Q3. Study Source B. What does the eyewitness account suggest about the power of the Ottoman Empire compared to Christian Europe in 1453?

Drawing Task: Q4 Drawing Task: Draw a quick sketch comparing a poor European peasant's hut in 1450 with the grand palace of the Ming Emperor or Oba of Benin.

Q5 Knowledge Check: Global Power in 1450

1. How does the reality of the Thirteen Factories in Canton challenge the idea that Europeans dominated global trade in the 1700s?

- ☐ Europeans were forced to stay in small, confined trading posts
- ☐ Europeans owned the entire city of Canton
- ☐ The Chinese refused to trade entirely
- ☐ Europeans had stronger armies than the Ming Emperor

Q6. Study Source D. How does the artist use scale, chaos, and religious imagery to emphasize the sheer trauma of the Fall of Constantinople for Christian Europe?

Q7. Study Source D (Fresco of the Siege of Constantinople). What military technologies or tactics are visible in this depiction of the 1537 siege?

Q8. Study Source E (the 16th-Century Benin Bronze Plaque). How does this artifact challenge traditional European assumptions about pre-colonial African societies?

Q9. What impression do Sources E and F give about the balance of power between Europe and the rest of the world in the 15th century?

Think-Pair-Share: Q10 Class Debate: Based on Professor Frankopan's argument, why might traditional European textbooks have deliberately ignored the wealth of the East in 1450?

1. My Thoughts (Think)	2. Partner's Thoughts (Pair)

Q11. How does the evidence in Source F and the description of the peasant's 'pottage' contrast with the lives of the Oba of Benin or the Ming Emperor?

Q12. Why does this evidence support the idea that Europe was an 'isolated outpost' in 1450?

Scaffolding & Hints:

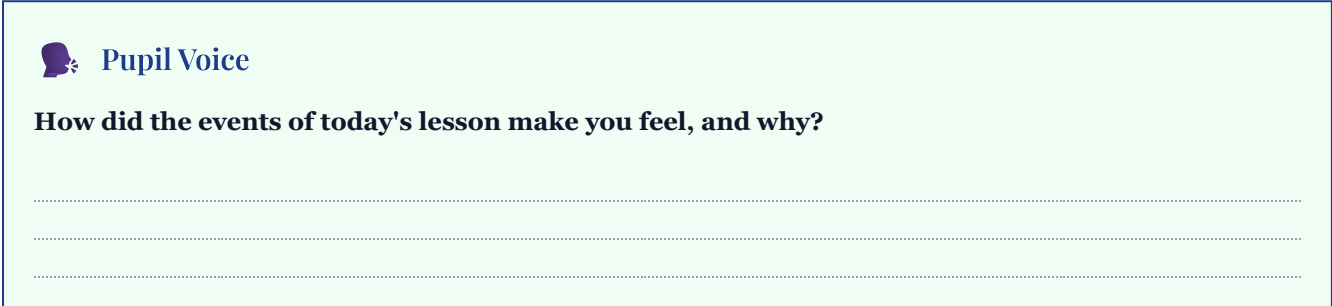
- Mention the Ming Dynasty (China), the Islamic Empires (Ottoman/Mali), and the Silk Road.
- Sentence Starter: In 1450, the true centers of global wealth were...
- Sentence Starter: This was because they controlled...
- Sentence Starter: By contrast, Europe was relatively isolated because...

- Scaffolding & Hints:**

 - Mention the Ming Dynasty (China), the Islamic Empires (Ottoman/Mali), and the Silk Road.
 - Sentence Starter: In 1450, the true centers of global wealth were...
 - Sentence Starter: This was because they controlled...
 - Sentence Starter: By contrast, Europe was relatively isolated because...

Q13. Explain why Europe was not the center of global wealth and power in 1450.

[12 marks • 15 mins]

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 Pupil Voice

How did the events of today's lesson make you feel, and why?

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General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L2: How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how the Protestant Reformation shattered European unity after 1517.
- ☐ Analyze the role of Elizabethan privateers in challenging Catholic Spain's global monopoly.
- ☐ Evaluate how the Spanish Armada (1588) marked a turning point in Britain's imperial ambitions.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. What was the overarching name for the ancient trade network connecting Asia to Europe?

2. Which major empire expanded to block overland European trade routes in 1453?

3. What city was captured by Sultan Mehmed II in 1453?

4. What West African kingdom was known for its detailed bronze plaques in the 15th century?

5. Why did the capture of Constantinople force European nations to look for new trade routes?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Reformation | Privateer | Armada | Monopoly | Indulgences

Your Sentence:

Q1. Why did the Spanish attack Francis Drake and at San Juan de Ulúa despite having signed a truce?

Drawing Task: Q2 Drawing Task: Sketch the crescent formation of the Spanish Armada being attacked by English fireships.

Q3. Study Source A (Portrait of Gerardus Mercator). Why was Mercator's 1569 map projection a revolutionary development for early modern sailors?

Q4. Look at Source C. Why would a map showing the Pope dividing the entire undiscovered world between Spain and Portugal absolutely infuriate Protestant monarchs like Queen Elizabeth I?

Q5. How did Queen Elizabeth I use privateers as a strategic tool against Spain?

Q6. Describe the two main reasons the Spanish Armada failed to invade England.

Q7. How does the author's perspective in Source C differ from Source B regarding Francis Drake and the conflict?

Q8. What message was the artist of the Armada Portrait trying to convey about England's future?

Q9. Study Source F (The Armada Portrait of Queen Elizabeth I). How does the artist use symbolism in this painting to project Elizabeth's power following the defeat of the Spanish Armada?

Q10. How does the revisionist view (Perspective B) challenge the traditional view (Perspective A) of the Armada's defeat?

Think-Pair-Share: Q11 Why might history textbooks prefer to focus on the 'glory' of Francis Drake rather than the reality of scurvy?

1. My Thoughts (Think)	2. Partner's Thoughts (Pair)

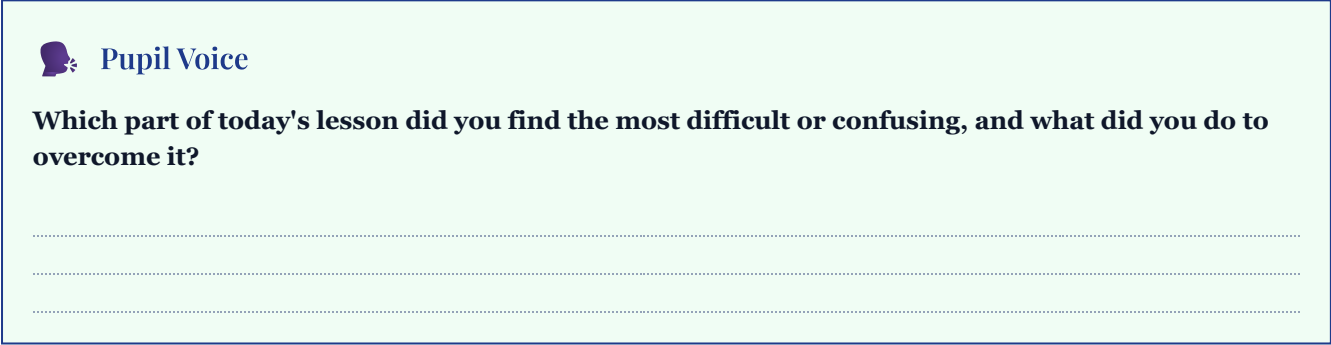
Q12 Number these events from 1 to 4 in the order they happened.

- ☐ The Spanish Armada is defeated by the English fleet and bad weather.
- ☐ Martin Luther pins his 95 Theses to the door, beginning the Protestant Reformation.
- ☐ Francis Drake circumnavigates the globe and raids Spanish treasure ships.
- ☐ The Pope splits the 'New World' between Spain and Portugal.

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention Henry VIII, the Pope, privateers (Francis Drake), and the Spanish Armada.
- Sentence Starter: When England became Protestant, it created conflict with Catholic Spain because...
- Sentence Starter: To challenge Spain's wealth in the New World, English monarchs encouraged...
- Sentence Starter: This rivalry culminated in...

- ### Scaffolding & Hints:
- Mention Henry VIII, the Pope, privateers (Francis Drake), and the Spanish Armada.
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 Pupil Voice

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Teacher Comment:

L3: Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how joint-stock corporations (like the East India Company and Virginia Company) funded early English expansion.
- ☐ Compare the early English colonial encounters in North America (Roanoke and Jamestown) with mercantile trade in Mughal India.
- ☐ Evaluate the turning point where peaceful commercial trade shifted into territorial takeover and subjugation.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. In what year did Martin Luther post his 95 Theses?

2. What name was given to English sailors, like Francis Drake, who were given legal permission to attack Spanish ships?

3. What was the name of the Spanish King who launched the Armada against England in 1588?

4. What weather event destroyed much of the fleeing Spanish Armada off the coast of Scotland?

5. Why did Queen Elizabeth I use privateers instead of the Royal Navy to challenge Spain in the Americas?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Joint-Stock Company**

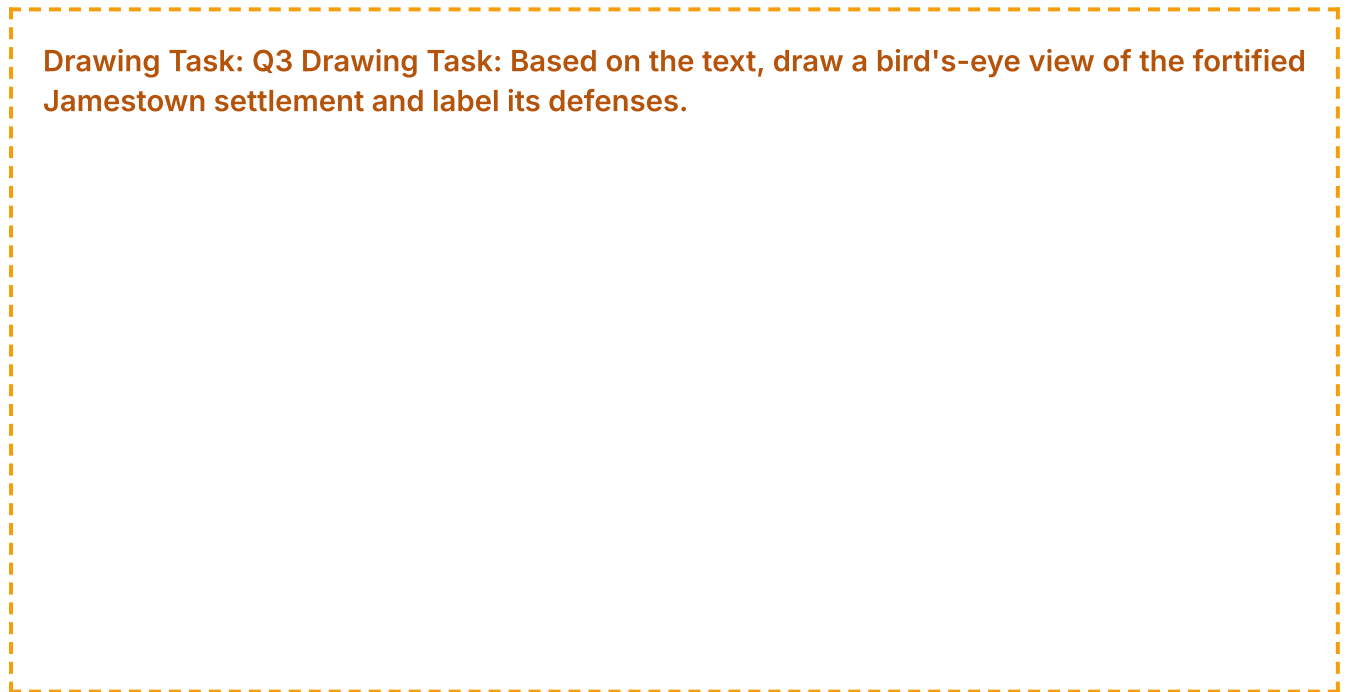
Q1 Fill in the blanks using the words provided to summarize the story of Matoaka (Pocahontas).

Word Bank: propaganda | James I | converted | Pocahontas

Matoaka, often known as [.], was brought to the court of King [.] in London. The Virginia Company used her as a living piece of [.] to convince wealthy investors that the indigenous people of America could be 'civilized' and [.] to Christianity, hiding the brutal reality of the early colonial encounters.

Q2. How did the funding of early English colonial expansion differ from the Spanish model?

Drawing Task: Q3 Drawing Task: Based on the text, draw a bird's-eye view of the fortified Jamestown settlement and label its defenses.



Q4. Study Source A (Sir Thomas Roe at the Mughal Court). What does this image suggest about the balance of power between English ambassadors and the Mughal Empire in 1615?

Q5. What was the primary motivation stated in Source B for colonizing Virginia, and why might the Virginia Company emphasize religious duty over profit?

Q6. Using Source C, explain why the East India Company was forced to act politely toward Mughal rulers in 1616, whereas English settlers in Virginia acted aggressively toward Native Americans.

Q7. How does the reality of the Thirteen Factories in Canton challenge the idea that Europeans dominated global trade in the 1700s?

Q8. What does the design of the Jamestown Fort suggest about the relationship between the English settlers and the local indigenous population?

Think-Pair-Share: Q9 How do Perspective A and Perspective B disagree on the origins of the British Empire?

1. My Thoughts (Think)	2. Partner's Thoughts (Pair)

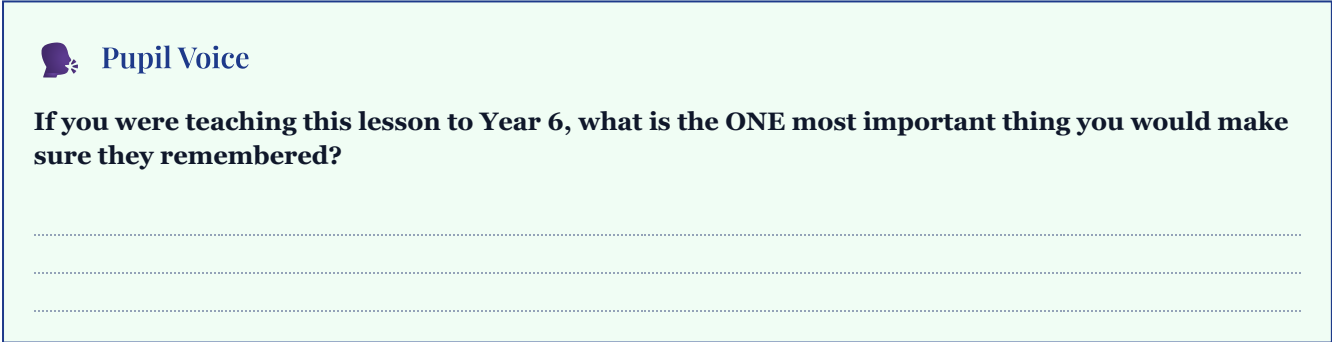
Q10. How does this 'ground-up' detail change our understanding of why Native Americans became hostile to the Jamestown settlers?

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention joint-stock companies, monopolies, violence, and Asian spices/textiles.
- Sentence Starter: Before the EIC, individual merchants struggled to trade in Asia because...
- Sentence Starter: The EIC solved this by using a 'joint-stock' model, which meant...
- Sentence Starter: However, they often used violence to secure a 'monopoly', allowing them to...

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 - Mention joint-stock companies, monopolies, violence, and Asian spices/textiles.
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 - Sentence Starter: However, they often used violence to secure a 'monopoly', allowing them to...

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 **Pupil Voice**

If you were teaching this lesson to Year 6, what is the ONE most important thing you would make sure they remembered?

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Teacher Comment:

L4: James I and the Gunpowder Plot: Why was religious division so volatile?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the religious tensions between Protestants and Catholics that motivated the Gunpowder Plot of 1605.
- ☐ Analyse the Monteleone Letter as evidence of divided Catholic loyalties in Early Modern England.
- ☐ Evaluate the long-term consequences of the Gunpowder Plot for Catholic rights and religious toleration in England.

Q1. The Foreign Diplomat's Confidential Dispatch

Take on the role of a foreign ambassador visiting London in 1605. Write a confidential report back to your home court explaining why religious division in England is so intense. Include your impressions of King James, his falling out with Church leaders and Parliament, and the growing Catholic resentment over the expulsion of priests.

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Q2. Prosecution Speech at Westminster

It is 27 January 1606, and the trial of the surviving conspirators has begun before Lord Chief Justice Sir John Popham. Write the opening speech for the prosecution outlining the charges—treason, attempted murder of the King, and conspiracy to reintroduce Catholicism—explaining why treason against the Protestant Crown requires the harshest public punishment.

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Q3. Eyewitness Letter Home

Imagine you were a Londoner who witnessed the capture of Guy Fawkes and the subsequent execution of the conspirators in January 1606. Write a letter to a friend describing the mood of the city, explaining why most citizens were relieved the plot failed, and reflecting on how the King wants the fifth of November remembered.

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Q4. What can you infer from Source A about how the plotters were viewed by contemporaries?

Q5. How useful is Source A for understanding the threat posed by the Gunpowder Plot?

Q6. How does Source B provide evidence of Jacobean interrogation methods?

Q7 Follow-Up Investigation: The Monteagle Letter

Enquiry Field	Student Response
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Q8. Was the Gunpowder Plot caused entirely by the persecution of English Catholics?

"The Gunpowder Plot was caused entirely by the harsh persecution and broken promises of King James I." How far do you agree with this statement? In your answer, ensure you: - Examine the impact of recusancy penalties and the banishment of Catholic priests. - Consider alternative perspectives, including religious extremism or political exploitation by Robert Cecil. - Conclude with a clear, balanced historical judgement supported by evidence.

Q9. Study Source C. What does this execution scene suggest about how the government punished treason in the 17th century?

Lesson Consolidation

Reflect on today's learning and answer your teacher's final challenge.



Pupil Voice

What is one question about today's topic that we didn't answer, that you'd like to research further?

General Notes

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- ☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L5: Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Analyze why King Charles I and Parliament fought the English Civil War (1642–1651).
- ☐ Evaluate how colonial wealth from sugar and tobacco reshaped British politics during the Commonwealth.
- ☐ Debate who held true power in Britain by 1660: the Monarchy, Parliament, or Atlantic Capitalists.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. What was the name of the first permanent English settlement in North America (1607)?

2. Which cash crop saved the Jamestown colony from economic ruin?

3. What type of business model was the East India Company (EIC), where multiple investors pooled money?

4. Which powerful Asian empire did Sir Thomas Roe visit in 1615?

5. Why were the English submissive traders in India, but aggressive conquerors in North America?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Divine Right of Kings | New Model Army | Commonwealth | Plantation | Navigation Acts

Your Sentence:

Q1 How useful is this painting as evidence of Britain's global power and ideology in 1778? [p. 24]

Q2 Study Source A. Why did the monarch combine the English and Scottish symbols into a single Coat of Arms?

Q3. Why was the execution of King Charles I such a shocking event in European history?

Q4. Study Source A. Why did the monarch combine the English and Scottish symbols into a single Coat of Arms?

Q5. How did the Atlantic Merchants use their wealth to influence the outcome of the English Civil War?

Think-Pair-Share: Q6 How does Source C reveal a completely different reason for Parliament's victory over the King compared to the official reason given in Source B?

1. My Thoughts (Think)	2. Partner's Thoughts (Pair)

Q7. Look at Source D. What does Cromwell accuse MPs of becoming? Why is this ironic given that merchant wealth helped bring Cromwell to power?

Q8. Which historian argues that the conflict was primarily about political and class rights, and which argues it was about establishing the conditions for global capitalism and empire?

Q9. What radical belief did the Diggers hold about private property and the earth?

Q10. Why did wealthy Parliamentarians like Oliver Cromwell violently crush the Diggers?

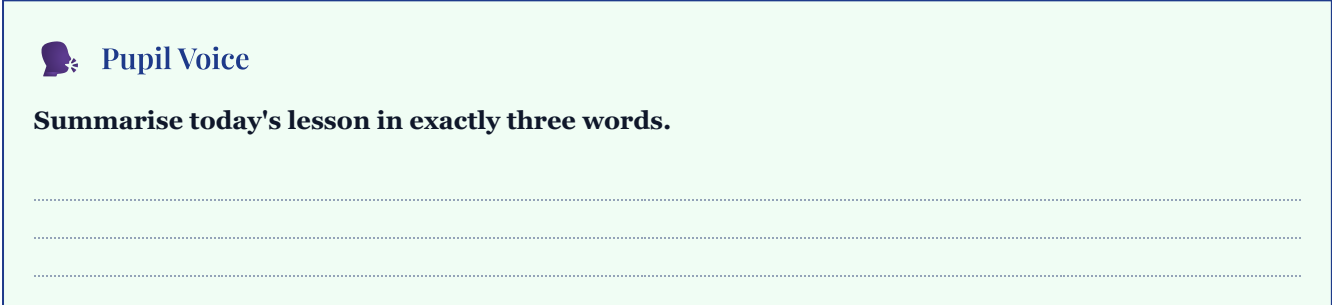
Q11. Lesson Reflection: Was the English Civil War a true revolution that gave power to the people, or just a transfer of power from the King to wealthy Parliamentarians? Use the IDEA framework to structure your response.

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention the Divine Right of Kings, Parliament, and Oliver Cromwell.
- Sentence Starter: Before the Civil War, Charles I believed in the 'Divine Right of Kings', meaning...
- Sentence Starter: However, Parliament challenged this by...
- Sentence Starter: By executing the King in 1649, it proved that...

- Scaffolding & Hints:**

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[illegible]

 Pupil Voice

Summarise today's lesson in exactly three words.

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Teacher Comment:

L6: Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain how 17th-century colonial trade in sugar, tobacco, and textiles generated unprecedented wealth for Britain.
- ☐ Analyse how the founding of the Bank of England (1694) and joint-stock companies created a Financial Revolution.
- ☐ Evaluate whether merchant capitalism had overtaken the monarchy as the true engine of British power by 1700.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 5

1. What political belief held that kings were chosen directly by God and possessed absolute power?

2. What was the name of the illegal tax on coastal (and later inland) towns revived by Charles I during his Eleven Years' Tyranny?

3. What was the name of Parliament's disciplined, professional military force created during the Civil War?

4. Who served as the commander of the New Model Army and later became 'Lord Protector' of England?

5. On what date was King Charles I executed outside the Banqueting House in London?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Divine Right of Kings**

Q1 Study Source E (The Great Seal of the Commonwealth of England). How does the imagery on this 1651 seal reflect the political upheaval following the execution of Charles I?

Q2 Look at Source E. What did the design of the 1651 Great Seal signal about Britain's new priorities compared to the previous 600 years?

Q3. Based on Source A, how did the visual appearance of London change as it became a global financial hub?

Q4. Look at Source E. What did the design of the 1651 Great Seal signal about Britain's new priorities compared to the previous 600 years?

Think-Pair-Share: Q5 How do Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 differ in identifying the true 'winner' of the Civil War?

1. My Thoughts (Think)	2. Partner's Thoughts (Pair)

Assessment Practice

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention the National Debt, the Bank of England (1694), and funding the Royal Navy.
- Sentence Starter: Following the Glorious Revolution, Britain created the Bank of England, which allowed the government to...
- Sentence Starter: This 'National Debt' was crucial because...
- Sentence Starter: Consequently, Britain could out-spend its rivals by building...

Q6. Explain how the 'Financial Revolution' (like the Bank of England) helped Britain build a modern empire.

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 **Pupil Voice**

If you could interview one historical person from today's lesson, who would it be and what would you ask them?

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Teacher Comment:

L7: What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Describe the mechanics of the Triangular Trade and the horrors of the Middle Passage.
- ☐ Analyse how the Caribbean plantation system created a brutal "death camp" model of forced labour.
- ☐ Evaluate the extent to which the profits of the slave trade built modern Britain.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 3

1. What is a 'joint-stock company'?

2. What cash crop saved the Jamestown colony from economic failure?

3. Who won the English Civil War (1642-1651)?

Vocabulary Check

Write a short paragraph using at least *THREE* of the vocabulary words below correctly.

Triangular Trade | Middle Passage | Plantation

Q1. How did powerful African empires like the Dahomey acquire people to sell into slavery?

Q2. What goods did European merchants trade in exchange for enslaved people?

Q3. Study Source A. What does the heavy fortification of Cape Coast Castle tell us about the nature of the slave trade?

Drawing Task: Q4 Drawing Task: Draw a flowchart mapping the 'Triangular Trade' between Europe, Africa, and the Americas, labeling the goods traded at each point.

Q5. Based on Source B (the flowchart), what specific goods were exchanged for enslaved Africans in West Africa?

Q6. What is an 'absentee landlord'?

Q7. Why was the Caribbean sugar system often described as a 'death camp' model?

Q8. Study Source C. Why do you think absentee landlords back in London were able to ignore the brutality shown in illustrations like this?

Q9. UCL Research Task Worksheet: Summarize the core findings."I - Identify (make your point)\nD - Describe (give historical evidence/detail)\nE - Explain (how the evidence supports the point)\nA - Analyse (link back to the question and evaluate significance)" style="text-decoration: underline dotted; cursor: help;">IDEA framework to structure your response.

Q10. Lesson Reflection: How did the reality of the Transatlantic Slave Trade and the brutal 'death camp' model of the Caribbean sugar plantations challenge the idea that 18th-century Britain was a 'modern', enlightened, and civilized society? Use the IDEA framework to

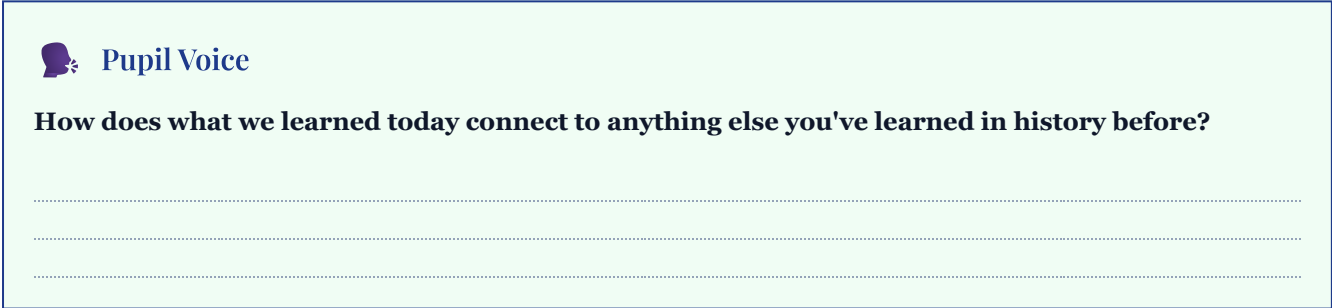
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Scaffolding & Hints:

- Mention Bristol/Liverpool, manufactured goods, enslaved people, and sugar/tobacco.
- Sentence Starter: The Triangular Trade enriched Britain through three main stages. Firstly...
- Sentence Starter: Secondly, enslaved Africans were brutally transported to...
- Sentence Starter: Finally, the immense profits from raw materials (like sugar) flowed back into British ports like...

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 **Pupil Voice**

How does what we learned today connect to anything else you've learned in history before?

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Teacher Comment:

L8: How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Explain the different methods of resistance used by enslaved Africans, including mutiny, rebellion, and cultural preservation.
- ☐ Analyse how the Jamaican Maroons used guerrilla warfare to successfully resist British colonial power.
- ☐ Evaluate the significance of enslaved resistance in challenging the moral foundations of the Transatlantic Slave Trade.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 3

1. What were the three legs of the Triangular Trade?

2. What was a 'barracoon'?

3. Why was sugar known as a 'killer crop'?

Vocabulary Check

Write a historically accurate sentence connecting two terms from the glossary box below.

Obeah | Maroons | Covert Resistance

Your Sentence:

Q1. Study Source B. How did the geography of Jamaica shown in the map help the Maroons wage a successful guerrilla war against the British?

Q2. How does the story of Queen Nanny challenge the traditional historical narrative about the abolition of slavery?

Drawing Task: Q3 Drawing Task: Sketch a visual representation of Queen Nanny's hidden mountain stronghold and how it helped the Maroons resist the British.

Q4. Give one example of covert resistance and explain why an enslaved person might choose it over overt resistance.

Q5. Inferring Motive (Source A): Why did jumping overboard represent a powerful act of resistance for enslaved Africans, even though it resulted in death?

Q6. Evaluating Significance (Equiano's Portrait & Source A): Why was Equiano's autobiography so historically revolutionary when published in London in 1789?

Q7. Based on the geography in Source D, why did the Stono Rebellion march specifically head South towards St. Augustine rather than inland, and what does this reveal about international rivalries?

Q8 Match the aspects of the Stono Rebellion to their correct historical descriptions.

The Cause		The Spanish promised freedom in Florida to any enslaved person who escaped.
The Event		A group of 20 enslaved Africans broke into a store, armed themselves, and marched south beating drums.
The Consequence		The British planters passed the brutal Negro Act of 1740, heavily restricting movement, assembly, and education.

Think-Pair-Share: Q9 Compare Source F with the story of Queen Nanny. Why is it dangerous to rely solely on portraits like Source C when trying to understand how and why the slave trade was eventually abolished?

1. My Thoughts (Think)	2. Partner's Thoughts (Pair)

Think-Pair-Share: Q10 What is the 'White Savior Narrative' in the context of the slave trade?

1. My Thoughts (Think)	2. Partner's Thoughts (Pair)

Q11. According to modern historians like Eric Williams, what were the *true* underlying reasons slavery ended?

Q12. Study Source F (Portrait of a British politician and abolitionist). Why were portraits like this important for the abolitionist movement in the late 18th century?

Q13. Lesson Reflection: Why is it historically inaccurate and damaging to claim that the abolition of the slave trade was purely the result of benevolent white politicians like William Wilberforce? Use the IDEA framework to structure your response.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

Q14. Study Source E. Why might enslaved people's deep botanical knowledge of plants like cassava have been a more terrifying form of resistance for plantation owners than an armed rebellion?

Q15. Why might psychological and chemical resistance have been just as effective as armed rebellion?

- Mention Nanny of the Maroons, guerrilla warfare, and the geography of Jamaica.
- Sentence Starter: The Maroons were communities of...
- Sentence Starter: They were able to successfully resist the British army because they used...
- Sentence Starter: Ultimately, the British were forced to...

Q16. Explain how the Jamaican Maroons successfully resisted British control.

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Pupil Voice

How did the events of today's lesson make you feel, and why?

General Notes

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☐ Emerging (1-2) ☐ Emerging+ (3) ☐ Expected (4-5) ☐ Expected+ (6-7) ☐ Greater Depth (8-9)

Teacher Comment:

L9: How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- ☐ Define what historians mean by a 'modern' state in the context of 18th-century Europe.
- ☐ Synthesise domestic social realities with imperial/commercial expansion across the period 1450–1750.
- ☐ Construct a high-level, structured final essay evaluating the extent of Britain's 'modernity' by 1750.

Do Now Activity

Score: / 4

1. What was the primary function of the 1607 Jamestown Fort design?

2. Why did Oliver Cromwell execute King Charles I in 1649?

3. What was the strategic advantage of the Jamaican Maroons' location?

4. What motivated the creation of the Royal African Company?

Vocabulary Check

Write a clear definition and a historically accurate sentence for the term: **Modernity**

Q1. Study Source A. How does this painting glorify the British Empire while masking the brutal realities of colonization?

Drawing Task: Q2 Drawing Task: Draw a single symbol or logo that you feel best represents the state of 18th-century Britain (e.g., a combination of a bank, a ship, and chains).

Q3. Based on Source B , identify one piece of political evidence that proves Britain was modern, and one piece of political evidence proving it was un-modern.

Think-Pair-Share: Q4 Reconciling Contradictions: How can Source C and Source D offer completely opposite views of Britain in the late 1740s/1750s without either author necessarily lying?

1. My Thoughts (Think)	2. Partner's Thoughts (Pair)

Q5. Synthesis Challenge: Combine the insights from Sources C and D with your knowledge of the Atlantic Slave Trade to write a nuanced 3-sentence summary of British society in 1750.

Q6. How does the density and infrastructure of London shown in Source E (1746) provide hard evidence for a 'modernizing' Britain compared to the agricultural society you studied in 1450?

Q7 Assessment Planner: Structure your argument before you write your final essay.

[8 marks • 10 mins]

Point (Your claim)	Evidence (Historical facts)	Explanation (Why this matters)

Q8. Map these historical realities onto the spectrum below to plan your argument.

Q9. Study Source F. How does the existence of 'Mudlarks' challenge the idea that 1750 London was entirely prosperous and modern?

Final Assessment

Scaffolding & Hints:

- **Intro:** Define modernity and state your overall argument (it was modern economically, but traditional socially).
- **Para 1 (Modern):** Discuss the Financial Revolution, Bank of England, and global trade (East India Company).
- **Para 2 (Traditional):** Discuss the brutal social realities (The Bloody Code, chattel slavery, Mudlarks).
- **Conclusion:** Summarise your judgment. Was the modernity just an illusion for the rich?

Q10. How 'modern' was Britain by 1750?

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Pupil Voice

Which part of today's lesson did you find the most difficult or confusing, and what did you do to overcome it?

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Teacher Comment:

End of Unit Assessment: How 'modern' was Britain by 1750?

Scaffolding & Hints:

- Intro: Define what historians mean by a 'modern' state and state your overall argument.
- Para 1 (Modern): Discuss the Financial Revolution (Bank of England), constitutional monarchy (Glorious Revolution), and global trade (East India Company, Triangular Trade).
- Para 2 (Un-Modern): Discuss the brutal social realities — the Bloody Code, chattel slavery, fewer than 5% of men could vote, women had no legal rights, urban poverty (Mudlarks, Gin Craze).
- Para 3 (Evaluation): Was the wealth of 1750 built on exploitation? Can a society be called 'modern' if its prosperity depends on slavery?
- Conclusion: Reach a nuanced judgment. Perhaps Britain was economically modern but socially medieval — a 'modern veneer over a brutal reality'.

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[16 marks • 20 mins]

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Exam Sources & Interpretations

Source A

Interpretation 1 (based on Paul Langford, 'A Polite and Commercial People', 1989): By 1750, Britain was already the world's first truly modern state. The Civil War and Glorious Revolution had replaced absolute royal tyranny with a constitutional monarchy governed through Parliament. The Bank of England (founded 1694) had invented the modern system of national debt and paper credit, allowing Britain to out-finance every rival in Europe. A vast global trade network stretched from India to the Caribbean, and over 1,500 miles of turnpike roads connected the nation. In commerce, finance, and political freedom, Britain was two hundred years ahead of the continent.

Source B

Interpretation 2 (based on J.C.D. Clark, 'English Society 1688–1832', 1985): The idea that 18th-century Britain was a 'modern' nation is a dangerous myth. In reality, it remained a deeply traditional, unequal, and brutal society. Less than 5% of the male population could vote, and corrupt 'rotten boroughs' allowed wealthy aristocrats to buy their way into Parliament. The terrifying 'Bloody Code' imposed the death penalty for over 200 minor crimes. Britain's economic wealth was built entirely upon the barbaric machinery of the Transatlantic Slave Trade, in which millions of Africans were treated as property. For the vast majority of the population — the urban poor, women, and enslaved people — 1750 Britain was not modern at all.

Q2. 1. What is the main difference between Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 regarding how 'modern' Britain was by 1750?

[4 marks • 5 mins]

Q3. 2. Suggest one reason why Interpretation 1 and Interpretation 2 give different views about Britain by 1750. You may use evidence from this unit to help explain your answer.

[4 marks • 5 mins]

TEACHER FEEDBACK / D.I.R.T.

1

[16 marks • 20 mins]

[illegible]

[illegible]



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Teacher Comment:

End of Unit Reflection & Pupil Voice

Unit: Early Modern World (1450–1750)

Instructions: Now that you have completed your final assessment, take 10 minutes to reflect on your learning across this entire unit. Be honest—this is your chance to use your **Pupil Voice** to help your teacher plan future lessons.

1. What Went Well (WWW)

What topic or skill did you find most engaging or easiest to understand in this unit?

2. Even Better If (EBI)

What did you find most challenging? Are there any concepts you are still confused about?

3. Effort & Target Setting

Circle your effort level for this unit: **1 (Low)** **2** **3** **4** **5 (Excellent)**

What is one specific target you want to set for yourself in the next unit?

Teacher Feedback & Coaching

(To be completed during live marking / feedback lessons)